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CTSM No. 307

TO : MS. KESIA AMOR M. VALENCIA

SUBJECT : 53RD ANNUAL CONVENTION AND SCIENTIFIC MEETING OF THE PHILIPPINE SOCIETY FOR MICROBIOLOGY, INC (PSM)-NATIONAL

DATE : JULY 16, 2024

You are hereby authorized to attend the Poster Presentation at the **53RD ANNUAL CONVENTION AND SCIENTIFIC MEETING OF THE PHILIPPINE SOCIETY FOR MICROBIOLOGY, INC (PSM) - NATIONAL** on July 17 to 20, 2024 at the University of St. La Salle, Bacolod City.

Your attendance will be on official time only.

Please see attached letter for details.

For your information, guidance and compliance.

ANITA G. DAVID, Ed.D.
University President

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ANITA G. DAVID, Ed.D.
University President

PSAU-OPR-SF-03 | 02 (12-31-23)

Republic of the Philippines
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July 11, 2024

ANITA G. DAVID, Ed.D.
SUC President IV
Pampanga State Agricultural University
Magalang, Pampanga

Dear Dr. David:

A blissful day!

I would like to inform you that our paper entitled: "Detection of *Staphylococcus aureus* and its Methicillin-resistant Strain: A Basis for a Proposed Effective Infection Prevention and Control Program of Selected Government Hospitals in Pampanga", was accepted for Poster Presentation at the 53rd Annual Convention and Scientific Meeting of the Philippine Society for Microbiology, Inc. (PSM) – National, which will be held at the University of St. La Salle, Bacolod City on July 18-19, 2024.

Having this paper presented at the National level is a privilege, and it is indeed an opportunity to share such research as this may also provide awareness to people regarding Hospital-acquired Infections (HAIs) causing bacteria such as the *Staphylococcus aureus*.

In this regard, I humbly request your approval of my participation in this convention on Official Time from July 17-20, 2024. I will be using personal funds for the expenses covered by this travel.

I am hoping for your kind consideration. Thank you and God bless.

Respectfully yours,

KESIA AMOR M. VALENCIA
Instructor I
Department of Biology, CAS

7/12/24
9:36

Noted by:

EVELYN V. TOTAAN, Ph.D.
Chair, Department of Biology
Dean, College of Arts and Sciences

Recommending Approval:

MINALYN G. ALVIZ, M.A.Ed.
Acting Vice President for Administration and Finance

SYLVIA S. DE GUZMAN, Ed.D.
Vice President for Academic Affairs

Approved:

JANITA G. DAVID, Ed.D.
SUC President IV

THE PHILIPPINE SOCIETY FOR MICROBIOLOGY, INC.

PSM 53

MICROBIOLOGY IN THE DIGITAL ERA : OPEN SCIENCE AND POWER OF DATA

• JULY 18-19 2024 • UNIVERSITY OF ST. LA SALLE BACOLOD CITY

SEARCA HOTEL RESIDENCE BUSINESS CENTER, U.P. LOS BANOS, COLLEGE, 4031, LAGUNA , PHILIPPINES
TELEPHONE/FAX #: (+63) 49 536 5794, EMAIL : philsocmicro@yahoo.com , WEBSITE: psm.org.ph

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18 June 2024

Kesia Amor M. Valencia
Pampanga State Agricultural University
Magalang, Pampanga, 2011

Dear **Mr. Valencia:**

I would like to thank you for your abstract submission for the **53rd Annual Convention and Scientific Meeting of the Philippine Society for Microbiology, Inc. (PSM),** which will be held on **18-19 July 2024** at **University of St. La Salle, Bacolod City.**

In line with this, we are glad to inform you that your abstract entitled "Detection of *Stephylococcus aureus* and its Methicillin-resistant Strain: a Basis for a Proposed Effective Infection Prevention and Control Program of Selected Government Hospitals in Pampanga" is **ACCEPTED for Poster Presentation (Non-Competing-Professional: PP-P-NC-27)**.

I would like to request that you **sign the conforme** found in the next page and return to me together with the other requirements (see attached Instructions) **on or before 26 June 2024. Please take note that early registration fee applies for the presenting author.**

I would also like to sincerely apologize for the delay in releasing the result of the evaluation of your abstract submission.

Thank you very much!

Sincerely,

Sharon Yvette Angelina M. Villanueva, MMSc, PhD, RMicro, DPAM
Chair, Poster Presentation Committee
PSM 53rd Convention

Noted by:

Thaddeus M. Carvajal, PhD
President, PSM FY 2023-2024

Detection of *Staphylococcus aureus* and its Methicillin-resistant Strain: A Basis for a Proposed Effective Infection Prevention and Control Program of Selected Government Hospitals in Pampanga

Michael Angelo C. Nicdao[1], Mirriam S. Arenas[2], Kesia Amor M. Valencia[1], Evelyn V. Totaan[1], and Jacqueline V. Bagunu[1]

[1] Pampanga State Agricultural University, Magalang, Pampanga, 2011
[2] Dr. Andres J. Luciano District Hospital, Magalang, Pampanga, 2011

Corresponding author's email address: kesiaamor_valencia@psau.edu.ph

The establishment of an Infection Prevention and Control Program for environmental cleaning in district hospitals is equally important as in urban tertiary health institutions. Because safeguarding the health of patients, their guests, and hospital personnel is universal among medical institutions. Thus, this research assessed the cleaning program of selected district hospitals in Pampanga by detecting *Staphylococcus aureus* (*S. aureus*) and its methicillin-resistant strain (MRSA) on non-critical high-touch surfaces. The detection of the bacteria was used as a basis for introducing an infection prevention and control (IPC) program to the three hospitals. Its implementation by the hospitals was evaluated through measurement of the bacterial load in high-touch surfaces and detection of *S. aureus* and MRSA after environmental cleaning following the proposed IPC program. Results showed that *S. aureus* and MRSA were detected on different surfaces of the three hospitals but following environmental cleaning, the bacterial loads were reduced to sanitary level and the number of surfaces contaminated was eliminated in hospital B and reduced in hospitals A and C. However, the re-emergence of MRSA, after cleaning, in hospital A was noted. This may be attributed to a source, which is usually a patient. But it should not be discounted that hospital personnel, if have low hand hygiene compliance, may transmit this bacteria to other areas. Thus, the IPC program of each hospital should be continuously strengthened and hand hygiene compliance must also be reinforced and monitored. To accomplish this, this research is transformed into an extension project, which will assist the hospitals in monitoring, reviewing, auditing, and improving their IPC programs.

Keywords: *Staphylococcus aureus, MRSA, IPC program, District Hospitals*